HKU BUSINESS SCHOOL | MBA Programmes

PMBA6117 Digital Marketing Strategy

Nov 22, 29, Dec 6, 13, 20
Admiralty TC

GENERAL INFORMATION			
Instructor	Prof. Jayson S. JIA		
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Consultation times	Every Monday of the Module 4:00-5:00pm **Please make appointment by email in advance** (other times might be available)		
Pre-requisites Course Code & Title	N/A	**Co-requisites Course Code & Title**	N/A
Teaching Assistant	Name: Jiajia LIU (No Tutorials) Email: jiajia.liu@connect.hku.hk		
Other important details:	**Course Prerequisite** This course is designed to be accessible for students from a diverse set of backgrounds. An introductory level of statistics is helpful. Students with no statistics background are expected to learn (basic) linear regression and other basic statistics concepts/tools in their own time. Necessary software, analytics tools, and statistics will be covered in class.		

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course provides a strategic overview of the continuing developments in digital economy and marketing technologies that have fundamentally altered the nature, scope, and organization of consumers, businesses, and society at large. Substantive topics include: marketing strategy in the age of large language models (LLMs) and generative AI, digital experimentation, predictive analytics in CRM systems, social network strategy, mobile/location-based marketing, and understanding internet culture. In exploring these concepts, applications, and strategies this course aims to teach students how to create value in digital marketing contexts and create novel strategies as technology evolves. Students are expected to take an experiential learning approach in this class, which is comprised of lectures, discussions, live data-analysis demonstrations, multimedia, and cases from around the world. Assessments will be based on in-class participation, individual and group data exercises, and a student-led project and presentation.

Course Material will be distributed via Moodle. Please check Moodle regularly for udpates.

Group work: Students should self-organize into final project groups of 3-4 by Lesson 3. Please see instructor if you are unable to join a group by Lesson 3.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

1. To build a conceptual understanding of the marketing, and business science behind digital economy, online and digital marketing, and data-driven consumer products/services/platforms
2. To discuss and learn the scientific and marketing ideas, theories, and methodologies underpinning the modern study of digital economy and digital consumer behavior
3. To understand how digital data, internet technologies, and other evolving technologies change the business landscape.
4. To apply the knowledge and skills in developing digital marketing strategy and create managerial insight or new business opportunities in existing industries.

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of business knowledge and skills in key functional areas
PLO2: Application of business knowledge to solve business problems
PLO3: Development of managerial leadership and inculcating professional ethics and competency in business
PLO4: Developing Global Outlook
PLO5: Mastering communication skills

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes	**Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes**
CLO1: Understand the role of data assets, analytics, and AI in digital economy, and digital and marketing strategies from leading firms and platforms around the world	PLO1,2,3,4
CLO2: Introductory understanding of digital analytics, including digital data, ad data, unstructured UGC, social network analysis, and mobility analysis, and digital experimentation	PLO1,2,3,4
CLO3: Understand how to leverage digital technologies/data assets, platforms/markets, and ecosystems to formulate effective marketing and business strategies.	PLO1,2,3,4
CLO4: Identify and evaluate the opportunities and problems related to the Internet, digital platforms, digital social networks, mobility services, AI, and future technological changes	PLO1,2,3,4
CLO5: Apply the knowledge and skills in analyzing contemporary business cases and creating actionable strategies in response to or ahead of technological change	PLO1,2,3,4
CLO6: Synthesize, understand, and communicate analytical processes and thought frameworks to become better decision makers, thought leaders, and analysts.	PLO1,2,3,4,5

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	**Expected contact hour**	**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes**
T&L1. Interactive classroom discussion, class data lab, cases	30	CLO1,2,3,4,5,6
T&L2. Self-study: reading, class/case discussion prep, individual work	30	CLO1,2,3,4,5,6
T&L3. Final Project – Presentation and Paper	60	CLO1,2,3,4,5,6
Total	**120**	

TLA1: Interactive Lectures with Discussions/Class Work

- Interactive lectures by the instructor will illustrate and reinforce key digital marketing concepts and principles. Students are expected to have pre-class reading and preparations and encouraged to share their views and experience actively in class discussions to deepen their learning.
- Critical discussion of scientific research (from business/economics, social science, and general science research) and business cases. Multimedia (e.g., interviews and mini-cases) will be integrated in the lectures and class discussions. Students will be challenged to view digital marketing from different perspectives (e.g., as a researcher, manager, consumer) and positions in the digital ecosystem to enhance their critical thinking skills.
- Individual and group exercises during class time will be conducted to develop and reinforce managerial and theoretical understanding of material.
- Use of technology and analytical tools using digital trace data to deepen understanding of class concepts. Instructor led exercises and class work will be used to deepen students' learning and develop their application capability on specific topics. Students are expected to address issues posted in these class exercises and share their thoughts in class. Verbal/ written feedback from lecturer, peer, and/or self will be used to facilitate continuous learning.

Students will receive extensive support for the final project (the culmination of everything learned in the class), and the ideation process be a major part of the class learning experience.

TLA2: Self Study

- **Students are expected to have finish assigned readings before class** to prepare for class discussions/activities.
- Readings are mandatory. Content of previous week's readings will be discussed as part of class.
- Although this course is geared towards business leaders and business leaders (and not just analysts), students are expected to have a solid conceptual understanding of the technical material**.** You will not be able to manage or direct teams related to digital functions without this knowledge.
- Helpful 'how to guides' will be distributed so that students can master new analysis and software at their own pace. Students are also expected to review and integrate the materials for their final projects, and make use of AI tools to abet self-study.

TLA3: Final Project: Digital Marketing Proposal

- Group digital data project gives students a chance to demonstrate their methodological, applied, strategic, and theoretical understanding of class concepts.
- Major goals:
  - promote students' active learning
  - develop students' skills on critical thinking, analytical, problem-solving
  - deepen understanding of developments in analytical tools, technology, and society (including AI)
  - stimulate students' creativity
  - enhance students' skills on communication, presentation, and teamwork

Project Background and Requirements:

- **Project goals:** leverage digital technology or culture in creative ways to generate deep managerial insights and create value. There are many possible ways to approach this project, which can be an academic topic or an applied marketing project. Students should use a mixture of technical and social engineering to create marketing value or to generate novel insights on human behavior. Below are some possible project types:
- **Project structure:**
  All projects should have three basic aspects: 1) marketing technology, 2) solve a business/marketing problem, 3) design a marketing campaign to market the solution

  Recommended structure
  a) a thesis (idea; your idea; your thinking) based on a new digital cultural or technological marketing opportunity,
  b) digital marketing research (e.g., analysis using search, content, network, space/location, external data, and even ethnographic research on relevant digital communities) to derive novel insight,
  c) critical analysis and insights based on the research/marketing thinking *(b) and (c) can be combined in one section when appropriate
  d) novel strategic recommendations (and marketing strategy) based on this analysis that has two components:
  - A business/marketing solution (based on digital technology) to the problem you identified
  - a marketing campaign to market the solution/recommendations (include story board and genAI facilitated content exemplars as part of this)

  e) critical discussion of limitations, risks, future development
  *note that d) should be the 'meat' (i.e., main part) of the final paper, but d) should be built upon an idea that is developed through a), b), c)

Examples of project contexts

1) *Digital marketing campaign* (Default option): Plan an integrative campaign covering class concepts (digital intelligence, social networks, mobility, AI and content strategy, digital culture etc.) at three basic levels:
   a) a thesis based on a new digital cultural or technological opportunity,
   b) digital marketing research (e.g., statistical analysis of digital trends, and even ethnographic research on relevant digital communities) to derive novel insight,
   c) generate novel strategic recommendations (and marketing strategy) based on digital marketing research

2) *New technological market development.* Create a new digital marketing strategy for a technology company by expanding into a new domain. A fictional example is if Amazon wanted to launch a social network, or Meta wanted to launch a self-driving car service. Here, strategy should leverage existing data and digital assets in creative ways.

3) *Digital transformation.* Help a traditional company implement digital transformation, Most likely is some kind of partnership or M&A with a smaller tech company and to justify the synergies – emphasis will be in 'fit'.

4) *Analyzing a digital media or a techno-cultural phenomenon.* (social science research version of option 1) Creative applications of what we learned in class to a market or social phenomenon in the digital space. Focus on generating insight using tools we learned in class, e.g., apply network analyses to influencer networks in a certain cultural niche, study interactions (and conflict) between online communities, a new technological frontier. Emphasis will be on insight rather than managerial outcome. For example, in previous years, students studied *Dazi* culture on RedNote.

- ✦ You will be graded on how well you apply class content (both technical material and *thinking*). You are not expected to come up with radically new ideas or theory, but rather should try to apply ideas (or combinations of ideas) you learned in class in new business contexts.

Deliverables (**see A3 below)**

COURSE ASSESSMENT METHODS

Students will be assessed by a combination of the group work (50%) and individual work (50%). The table below indicates the weighting for each assessment task and the alignment of assessment tasks with teaching and learning activities and course learning outcomes:

Assessment Methods	**Weight**	**Teaching and Learning Activities (TLA)**	**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes**
A1. In-class Participation, Exercises, and Case Discussion	30%	TLA1, TLA2, TLA3, TLA4	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, CLO4
A2. Group Project ✦ Proposal (Presentation) (50%) ✦ Written Report (50%)	70%	TLA1, TLA2, TLA3, TLA4	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3, CLO4
Total	**100%**		

COURSE GRADE DESCRIPTORS

Individual student's final grade for the course will be assigned according to the accumulative score that s/he has obtained from all of the assessment tasks:

Course Final Grade = Class Participation (30%) + Project (70%)

A+, A, A-	Consistently demonstrate a thorough grasp of the subject as evidenced by achieving an outstanding performance in understanding of marketing principles and concepts, critical analysis and synthesis, application of knowledge, generation of insight, building strategic recommendations or analysis based on this insight, written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.
B+, B, B-	Frequently demonstrate a substantial grasp of the subject as evidenced by achieving a proficient performance in understanding of marketing principles and concepts, critical analysis and evaluation, application of knowledge, generation of insight, building strategic recommendations or analysis based on this insight, written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.
C+, C, C-	Occasionally demonstrate a general grasp of the subject as evidenced by achieving a moderate performance in understanding of marketing principles and concepts, analysis and evaluation, application of knowledge, generation of insight, building strategic recommendations or analysis based on this insight, written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.

D+, D	Demonstrate a partial grasp of the subject as evidenced by achieving an adequate performance in understanding of marketing principles and concepts, analysis and evaluation, application of knowledge, generation of insight, building strategic recommendations or analysis based on this insight, written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.
F	Demonstrate a poor grasp of the subject as evidenced by achieving a poor performance in understanding of marketing principles and concepts, analysis and evaluation, application of knowledge, generation of insight, building strategic recommendations or analysis based on this insight, written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.

Assessment Rubrics for Each Assessment

A1. In-class Participation, Exercises, and Case Discussion (30%)

- Students are expected to prepare for each class by completing pre-class assigned reading materials and actively participate and contribute to the class discussions and activities.
- Case preparation requires careful reading, and in some cases, data analysis for homework
- If students have missed a class, they are responsible for everything taught or announced in the class on the day of their absence. No make-up arrangement can be made for any missing class activities.
- With the purpose of continuous learning and improvement, the assessment of class participation is regarded in this course as an assessment for learning. Students are expected to (1) prepare for the pop-up class work by studying and integrating the learned knowledge in class and assigned readings, and (2) reflect on the self-learning strategy and effectiveness in the group process in the mid and/or end of the course.
- Class Participation will be assessed against the following criteria: (1) clarity and accuracy of responses in class discussions and activities and (2) frequency and quality of class contribution.

A+, A, A-	B+, B, B-	C+, C, C-	D+, D	F
Highly active participation, regular insightful contribution to class	Very active participation, regular contribution to class	Some active participation, occasional contribution to class	Irregular participation, irregular contributions to class	No active participation, rarely makes contribution to class

Fail	Pass
Did not complete the assignment, demonstrates a very poor grasp of the subject as evidenced by achieving a satisfactory performance in analysis and evaluation, application of knowledge	Completed the assignment, demonstrates an adequate grasp of the subject as evidenced by achieving a satisfactory/basic performance in analysis and evaluation, application of knowledge

A3. Group Project (70%)

Deliverables:
Each group is required to
(1) make a 15-20 minute group marketing plan **presentation** in class (ALL group members need to present, although presentation times do not have to be equal) followed by a 5minute Q&A session and
(2) submit a group written marketing plan **report** (~15 pages of text, Times New Roman 12, double spacing, plus supporting materials, tables, figures, and illustrations (these do not count to the 15 page limit)) by the due date (TBA). If you have a lot to say, it is okay to write a little more than 15 pages.

- Each group will be required to create a powerpoint for the presentation that covers:
    1. Introduction to the background, as well as strategic, conceptual, cultural or theoretical issue covered
    2. Analysis and evaluation of critical issues using concepts and methodologies learned in class
    3. Strategic use of methodologies is the most important part of the exercise (e.g., social network analysis, digital marketing metrics, diffusion strategy) will be graded on logic of proposed methodology/thinking, and not necessarily results of analysis.
    4. Recommendations using analysis and conceptual/strategic frameworks from class content and readings
    5. Be ready to answer critical questions from the audience.
    6. Group member assessments will be conducted at the end of the module punish free-riders. Every group member should try to make a roughly equal contribution.
- During presentations, every group member must speak. However, speaking time can vary across group members.

- The presentation and report (i.e., the final paper) can be written and organized in any style / follow any format that achieves the project goals.

Instructor will provide feedback on the group project and identify areas for improvement after the completion of group presentation.

1) 15-20 minute **presentation** of group project proposal in class followed by a 5minute Q&A session (slides on Moodle)
- the instructor will provide verbal and written feedback after the presentation

2**) final paper** for group project (15 pages, Times New Roman 12, double spacing, plus supporting materials, graphs, and visualizations which **do not** count to the 15 page limit) – submit Word Doc on Moodle
- there is no page limit for the appendix / supporting materials at the end of the paper

- Instructor will provide feedback on the group project and identify areas for improvement after the completion of group presentation.
- Group project contribution assessments (using **Teammates**) will be conducted at the end of the year to punish free-riders.

Project Content:
Detailed guidelines will be uploaded onto Moodle

Assessment Criteria for Group New Product/Service Marketing Plan Project	**Group Oral Presentation (100%)** (a summary of key analyses)	**Group Written Report (100%)** (full version with details)
Conceptual: Application of concepts, ideas, theories, and strategic business thinking from **this class**	30%	30%
Methodological/Analytical Insight/: Application of methodologies, analytical techniques, and conceptual logic from **this class** to generate insight, valuable strategic conclusions	20%	20%
Application/Execution/Recommendations: Applying digital marketing logic (i.e., concepts, topic, logic) from **this class** to 1) recommend and design an integrated digital marketing solution to a problem, and 2) design a marketing campaign based on logical development of that insight	40%	40%
Effectiveness of presentation/writing	10%	10%
Total:	**100%**	**100%**

Peer Evaluation for Group Work:

In normal cases, individual group members receive the same total score for their group's score. However, in some cases, individual group members' scores will be adjusted depending on their efforts, performance, and contributions to the group work based on an end-of-course *Self and Peer Evaluation Form* (online anonymous survey).

A+, A, A-	B+, B, B-	C+, C, C-	D+, D	F
Outstanding application and understanding of concepts and theories, methodologies, frameworks to generate deep insight, excellent written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.	Proficient application and understanding of concepts and theories, methodologies, frameworks to generate good insight, proficient written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.	Moderate application and understanding of concepts and theories, methodologies, frameworks to generate insight, moderate written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.	Partial application and understanding of concepts and theories, methodologies, frameworks, some written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.	Poor application and understanding of concepts and theories, methodologies, frameworks; poor written and verbal communication and teamwork skills.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

This course will provide continuous feedback to students. Students should expect to receive:

- Verbal feedback during class
- Assignment feedback for homework (pass/fail is used to check students are on course)
- Verbal or written feedback for project idea proposals
- Verbal and written feedback after presentations (which is the 40-50% completion mark for the final project)

- SETL questionnaire (online) will collect student feedback at the end of the course

COURSE POLICY

Late Assignment Penalty:
All assignments are required to be submitted on or before the specified due date and time to the assignment submission destination. The penalty policy for any late assignments will be as follows:

No. of days later than the due date:	Total point deductions
1 days	deduct 25%
2 days	deduct 50%
3 days	deduct 100%

HKU Regulations on Academic Integrity:
The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on plagiarism on http://www.hku.hk/plagiarism/.

Cheating or plagiarism of any kind would result in an automatic F grade for the course plus strict enforcement of all Faculty and/or University regulations regarding such behavior. Incident(s) of academic dishonesty will NOT be tolerated.

Academic dishonesty is a behavior in which a deliberately fraudulent misrepresentation is employed in an attempt to gain undeserved intellectual credit, either for oneself or for another. It includes, but is not necessarily limited to, the following types of cases:

a. Plagiarism - The representation of someone else's ideas as if they are one's own. Where the arguments, data, designs, etc., of someone else are being used in a paper, report, oral presentation, or similar academic project, this fact must be made explicitly clear by citing the appropriate references. The references must fully indicate the extent to which any parts of the project are not one's own work. Paraphrasing of someone else's ideas is still using someone else's ideas, and must be acknowledged.

b. Unauthorized Collaboration on Out-of-Class Projects - The representation of work as solely one's own when in fact it is the result of a joint effort.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY AND ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION

Turnitin Check:

- Students should avoid plagiarism and have proper citations for their work. Students' written assignments and reports will be sent to the Turnitin for originality check.

GenAI policy:

- Students are welcome to use GenAI tools particularly to support data analysis or copyediting
- See HKU GenAI policy and more details on GenAI and plagiarism

Additional Information on assigned projects will be uploaded throughout the semester

COURSE CONTENT AND TEACHING SCHEDULE	
Lesson	**Content**
Lesson 1	Introduction: Digital Marketing Funnel and Advertising Metrics
Lesson 2	Digital Experimentation and CRM ***i) Rocket Fuel case*** ii) Digital Experimentation: Attribution, Causality, and A/B testing iii) Quasi-experiments
Lesson 3	Insight Creation through Digital Trace Data i) ***Shein Case*** ii) Search data exercise iii) Text, sentiment, and UGC
Lesson 4	Social Networks 1: Organic Growth and Complex Contagions **i) Tencent red packet case** ii) Intro to social networks iii) Contagion and diffusion effects
Lesson 5	Social Networks 2: Structure of Influence i) Social network analysis I: Centrality ii) Influence and KOLs iii) Social network analysis II: Structure and Communities
Lesson 6	Mobility and Location Based Services i) Mobility Data ii) Location Based Services iii) Citi-bike Mobility data analysis exercise
Lesson 7	Digital Content Strategy i) Livestream commerce **ii) *Puma AI Influencer case***
Lesson 8	Techno-cultural Systems: Generating influence and Shaping Behavior in Digital Systems
Lesson 9	Time-Space-Connected Integrative Framework for Digital Marketing Strategy **i) THE YES case** ii) Mobile strategy iii) Marketing innovation and value creation with TSC
Lessons 10	Group Presentations (or alternatively 'workshop day') and feedback (**Teams of 3-4**)
REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS	

Course Materials:

- Cases
- Journal Papers and Research Reports via Moodle
- Articles Harvard Business Review (https://hbr.org/topics)

Reference Textbook(s)/Reading:

1. Salganik, Matthew J. *Bit by Bit: Social Research in the Digital Age*. Princeton University Press, 2017. *Can be read online for free at: https://www.bitbybitbook.com/
2. Philip Kotler etc. *Marketing 6.0: The Future Is Immersive*. Wiley, 2023.
3. Raj Venkatesan, Jim Lecinski, *The AI Marketing Canvas: A Five-Stage Road Map to Implementing Artificial Intelligence in Marketing*, Stanford Business Books, 2021